

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Zepto Cafe — Retention & Habit Loop

S5: Your Usual Reorder Card | S1: Chai O'Clock Push Notification

Document Status	Version	Date
Draft	v1.0	July 2026
Product	PM	Target Metric
Zepto Cafe	Rishi Raj Sahu	12% → 25% 30-day repeat rate (6 months)

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1. Problem Statement

Zepto Cafe — Zepto's in-app food and beverage ordering experience — is failing to convert first-time users into repeat customers. Primary research (n=15 valid office and hybrid respondents) shows that 47% of respondents have placed at least one Zepto Cafe order, yet only 12% have reordered — an 88% post-first-order drop-off. The core issue is not product awareness or even quality in isolation: it is that the app creates no habit loop after Order 1. Once a user completes their first order, the product goes silent — there is no personalised nudge, no friction-reducing reorder shortcut, and no mechanism to anchor a routine.

Meanwhile, 73% of the same respondents continue their daily chai and snack habit through nearby chai stalls or the office canteen, both of which offer zero-friction repeat behaviour. The business consequence is direct: Zepto Cafe's repeat rate sits at 12% against a 6-month target of 25%, and without closing the post-order engagement gap, no volume of first-time promotional spend will compound into sustainable retention.

2. Scope

In Scope

S5 — Your Usual Reorder Card: personalised last-order card on the Zepto Café home screen for eligible returning users.

S1 — Chai O'Clock Push Notification: daily push at user's inferred preferred order time, deep-linking to the reorder card.

Platforms: Android and iOS (Zepto mobile app, v-current).

Users: logged-in users with ≥ 1 prior Zepto Café order.

Geography: India only (v1).

Schedule: weekday delivery (Mon–Fri), excluding public holidays.

Out of Scope

New item discovery, browse, or search experience.

Discounts, vouchers, or promotional offers attached to the reorder card.

Multi-item reorder baskets (v1 covers single last-ordered item only).

Guest / unauthenticated users.

Web or desktop surfaces.

Push via WhatsApp, SMS, or email channels.

Weekend push delivery (v1).

International markets.

Phasing

Phase 1 (this PRD): S5 Reorder Card + S1 Push Notification — core habit-loop features.

Phase 2 (future): ML-inferred optimal push time, smart item substitution, loyalty-point tie-in.

3. Pain Points

P1 — No Engagement Mechanism After Order 1

Primary friction | F1 | Survey n=15

33% of first-time Zepto Cafe users reported forgetting the feature existed entirely. After order completion, the app sends no personalised follow-up, surfaces no reorder shortcut, and fires no time-anchored nudge. There is no CUE → ROUTINE → REWARD loop of any kind.

“I genuinely forgot Zepto Cafe existed.” — Survey respondent

P2 — Reordering Requires Too Many Steps

F4 | Competitive gap

Placing a repeat order on Zepto Cafe requires approximately 90 seconds of navigation. All four benchmarked competitors — Swiggy, Zomato, Blinkit, and Starbucks India — offer a one-tap or two-tap reorder path as standard. This friction is a direct blocker for the break-window use case, where office workers have 10–15 minutes and default to the zero-friction chai stall instead.

Source: Competitive analysis + survey (73% use chai stall, 60% use canteen)

P4 — Competing Habits Are Deeply Entrenched

F3 | Survey

73% of respondents currently use a nearby chai stall; 60% use the office canteen. Both are free or subsidised and require no app, no payment, and no wait beyond walking distance. Zepto Cafe's differentiated value — speed, variety, in-seat delivery — is not being communicated or experienced at the moment when the daily chai habit is being formed.

P5 — Discounts Do Not Drive Repeat Behaviour

Survey

When asked what would trigger a reorder, only 20% of respondents cited discounts — the lowest-ranked trigger in the survey. This rules out a discount-led retention strategy and confirms the need for habit architecture (CUE + REORDER SHORTCUT + REWARD) over promotional spend.

4. User Stories

Persona	High-Level Story	Sub Stories
Priya Office / hybrid worker, 24–32, orders snacks during work breaks	As Priya, I want to reorder my usual snack and chai in as few steps as possible so that I can place an order within my 10-minute break without thinking about it.	• As Priya, I want to see my last order surfaced on the home screen so that I don't have to navigate to find it. • As Priya, I want to reorder with a single tap so that I can confirm without re-selecting items. • As Priya, I want to receive a timely nudge at the right moment of my workday so that Zepto Cafe comes to mind before I walk to the chai stall.
Priya	As Priya, I want confidence that my order will arrive fresh and on time so that I'm not hesitant to reorder after a first experience.	• As Priya, I want to see quality indicators for my last order so that I can decide whether to reorder the same item. • As Priya, I want to give quick feedback after delivery so that my preferences are remembered next time.
Growth PM / Business	As the product team, we want to measure reorder behaviour at every stage of the habit loop so that we can identify where the funnel breaks and run targeted experiments.	• As the product team, we want to track Day-3 and Day-7 return rates by cohort so that we can measure the impact of habit-trigger interventions. • As the product team, we want push notification open rates segmented by time-of-day so that we can optimise CUE timing.

5. Mental Model

Priya's relationship with chai and snacks is not purely functional — it is social and rhythmic. The 4pm break is a group ritual: colleagues stand up together, someone says “chai?”, and the group walks out. Priya joins not just for the chai but to avoid being the one left alone at her desk. The competing behaviour is therefore not just a ₹10–15 chai stall — it is a social cue that Zepto Cafe cannot currently replicate or intercept.

When Priya has tried Zepto Cafe, her mental comparison for the reorder decision operates on two separate axes:

Price vs. Experience

The chai stall is ₹10–15, arrives hot, and is social. Zepto Cafe is ₹70, arrives at her desk, and arrives cold enough to create doubt. Priya is not price-insensitive — she is doing a value calculation where the stall wins on price, temperature, and social participation simultaneously. Zepto Cafe's differentiated value (in-seat delivery, no queue) only wins when Priya is heads-down in work and genuinely cannot leave her desk.

App Experience vs. Competitors

Priya's reference point for what a food app should do is Swiggy and Zomato — both of which surface her last order, send personalised nudges, and make her feel remembered. Zepto Cafe does none of this. Respondents explicitly noted that the absence of personalised communication from Zepto — compared to what they received from Swiggy and Zomato — caused them to forget Zepto Cafe existed on their phone entirely. The mental association was never formed.

The implication for S5 and S1 is precise: Zepto Cafe needs to fire a CUE at the moment Priya is alone at her desk and the group has already left — not before, not after. This is the only window where in-seat delivery is a genuine advantage over walking out. The right moment is approximately 3:45–4:00pm on weekdays, just before or as the group break begins.

6. Design Requirements

This section is written for designers. It describes what users must be able to accomplish — not how the system must behave internally. Designers have full creative and structural freedom within these outcome constraints.

DR-01 — Your Usual Reorder Card (S5)

User Story

As Priya, I want to see my last Zepto Cafe order surfaced on the home screen so that I can reorder in one tap without navigating through the app.

Acceptance Criteria

A user is considered to have successfully used this feature when they can:

- **See the card without searching:** The reorder card is visible on the Zepto Cafe home screen without scrolling, immediately after the user opens the app.
- **Identify their last order at a glance:** The card displays the item name, image, and price of their most recent order clearly enough to confirm it without tapping into it.
- **Reorder in one tap:** A single tap on the reorder CTA adds the item to cart and navigates the user to the cart screen — no item selection, no quantity picker, no re-navigation required.
- **Understand what happens next:** After tapping, the user sees immediate confirmation (cart icon updates, brief toast or animation) before reaching the cart screen.
- **Handle unavailable items gracefully:** If the last ordered item is unavailable, the card falls back to the second-most-recent order. If both are unavailable, the card shows an unavailability state with a Browse CTA that deep-links to the last ordered category.
- **Reach checkout quickly:** From card tap to order placement, the user completes the flow in no more than 2 screens.

DR-02 — Chai O’Clock Push Notification (S1)

User Story

As Priya, I want to receive a timely, personalised nudge from Zepto Cafe at the moment my afternoon break begins so that ordering feels effortless and I don’t default to walking out for chai.

Acceptance Criteria

A user is considered to have successfully used this feature when they can:

- **Receive the notification at the right moment:** The push arrives between 3:45–3:50pm on working weekdays — before the group break begins.
- **Feel personally addressed:** The notification references Priya’s last ordered item by name rather than sending generic promotional copy.
- **Act on it without opening the app first:** Tapping the notification takes Priya directly to the reorder card (DR-01) — not the app home screen or a category page.
- **Ignore it without penalty:** If Priya dismisses the notification, it does not re-fire the same day. She will not be spammed.
- **Control her notification preferences:** Priya can opt out of Chai O’Clock notifications from within the app without affecting other Zepto notification types.
- **See consistency between notification and app:** The item and price shown in the push notification match exactly what appears on the reorder card when she taps through.

7. Functional Requirements

Each block below corresponds to a single system behaviour. These stories are written independently of Section 3 — they are granular and implementation-level, not strategic.

S5 — Your Usual Reorder Card

FR-01 — Display last order on Zepto Cafe home screen

User Story

As a returning Zepto Cafe user, I want my last order surfaced on the home screen when I open the app so that I can see it without searching.

Functional Requirement

The system must fetch the user’s most recent completed Zepto Cafe order and render a reorder card in a fixed position on the Zepto Cafe home screen on every app session, for 7 days after the last completed order. After 7 days with no new order, the card is suppressed and the home screen returns to its default state.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN a user has at least one completed Zepto Cafe order within the last 7 days.

WHEN the user opens the Zepto Cafe section of the app.

THEN the home screen displays a reorder card showing the item name, item image, and unit price of the most recently completed order.

AND THEN the card is visible without scrolling.

GIVEN a user has no completed Zepto Cafe orders, or their last order is more than 7 days ago.

WHEN the user opens the Zepto Cafe section.

THEN no reorder card is shown and the home screen renders its default state.

FR-02 — One-tap add to cart from reorder card

User Story

As a returning user, I want to tap once on the reorder card and have my last order added to cart so that I reach checkout without re-selecting items.

Functional Requirement

The system must add the previously ordered item and quantity to the user's active cart in a single tap from the reorder card CTA and navigate the user to the cart screen.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN a user sees the reorder card on the home screen and the item is in stock.

WHEN the user taps the reorder CTA.

THEN the item is added to cart with the same quantity as the last order.

AND THEN the user is navigated to the cart screen within 1 second.

AND THEN the cart icon reflects the updated item count.

GIVEN the user already has items in their cart from a previous session.

WHEN the user taps the reorder CTA.

THEN the system displays a prompt: "You have items in your cart. Add to existing cart or start fresh?" with two CTAs.

AND THEN the user's cart is only modified after they explicitly choose an option — no silent replacement.

FR-03 — Unavailable item handling on reorder card

User Story

As a returning user, I want to be informed when my last ordered item is unavailable so that I am not shown a broken or misleading card.

Functional Requirement

The system must check item availability in real time when rendering the reorder card. If the last ordered item is out of stock or delisted, the system falls back to the second-most-recent order. If both are unavailable, the card displays an unavailability state with a Browse CTA that deep-links to the category of the last ordered item.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN a user's last ordered item is currently out of stock or delisted.

WHEN the home screen loads and the reorder card is rendered.

THEN the system checks the second-most-recent order for availability and renders the fallback card with that item.

AND THEN the fallback card is visually identical to the primary card and functions identically for reorder.

GIVEN both the last and second-most-recent orders are unavailable.

WHEN the home screen loads.

THEN the card displays an unavailability indicator and a Browse CTA.

AND THEN tapping the Browse CTA deep-links the user to the category of their last ordered item (e.g., Hot Beverages if they last ordered chai).

FR-04 — Cart confirmation feedback after one-tap reorder

User Story

As a returning user, I want immediate visual confirmation that my reorder was registered so that I am not uncertain whether my tap was successful.

Functional Requirement

The system must display a confirmation state immediately upon successful cart addition from the reorder card, before the cart screen loads.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN a user taps the reorder CTA on the reorder card.

WHEN the item is successfully added to cart.

THEN a confirmation indicator (toast, animation, or card state change) appears within 300ms of the tap.

AND THEN navigation to the cart screen begins.

GIVEN a user taps the reorder CTA and the network request fails.

WHEN the add-to-cart call returns an error.

THEN the card displays an error state with a retry option.

AND THEN the user is not navigated away from the home screen.

S1 — Chai O’Clock Push Notification

FR-05 — Schedule and deliver personalised push at break window

User Story

As a returning Zepto Cafe user, I want to receive a push notification between 3:45–3:50pm on working weekdays so that I am reminded to order before I default to walking out.

Functional Requirement

The system must schedule and deliver a personalised push notification to eligible users within the 3:45–3:50pm IST window, Monday–Friday, excluding public holidays. The notification must reference the user’s last ordered item by name. Eligibility window: the user must have placed an order within the last 15 calendar days. If delivery fails within the window, the system retries until 4:00pm IST; if still undelivered by 4:00pm, the notification is skipped for that day.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN a user has at least one completed Zepto Cafe order within the last 15 days and has not opted out of Chai O’Clock notifications.

WHEN 3:45pm IST is reached on a working weekday (non-public holiday).

THEN the user receives a push notification containing their last ordered item name and personalised copy.

AND THEN if delivery fails, the system retries until 4:00pm IST, after which the notification is skipped for that day.

AND THEN the notification is not delivered on weekends or public holidays.

GIVEN a user has not placed an order in more than 15 calendar days.

WHEN the scheduled push window arrives.

THEN no notification is sent. The push resumes automatically the day after the user places their next order.

FR-06 — Deep link from push notification to reorder card

User Story

As a user who taps the Chai O’Clock push, I want to land directly on the reorder card so that I do not have to navigate to find my last order.

Functional Requirement

The system must resolve the push notification tap to a deep link that opens the Zepto Cafe home screen with the reorder card in the foreground.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN a user receives the Chai O’Clock push notification.

WHEN the user taps the notification.

THEN the app opens directly to the Zepto Cafe home screen with the reorder card visible.

AND THEN the item displayed on the reorder card matches the item referenced in the notification copy.

GIVEN the user taps the notification but their session has expired (logged out).

WHEN the app opens.

THEN the user is taken to the login screen and redirected to the reorder card after successful authentication.

FR-07 — Notification frequency cap — no re-fire same day

User Story

As a user, I want the Chai O’Clock push to fire only once per day so that I do not feel spammed.

Functional Requirement

The system must suppress the Chai O’Clock notification for the remainder of the calendar day once it has been delivered, regardless of whether the user tapped, dismissed, or ignored it.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN the Chai O’Clock push has been delivered to a user on a given day.

WHEN any retry or duplicate trigger fires within the same calendar day.

THEN no second notification is sent.

GIVEN the user tapped the notification and placed an order.

WHEN the next working day's push window arrives.

THEN the notification fires again with updated last-order content.

FR-08 — User opt-out of Chai O'Clock notifications

User Story

As a user, I want to turn off Chai O'Clock notifications from within the app without affecting my other Zepto notification preferences.

Functional Requirement

The system must provide a granular notification preference toggle for Chai O'Clock notifications, separate from other push categories, accessible from app settings.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN a user navigates to notification preferences in the Zepto app settings.

WHEN the user locates the Chai O'Clock toggle and switches it off.

THEN the user no longer receives Chai O'Clock push notifications.

AND THEN all other Zepto notification types continue to function without change.

GIVEN a user has opted out of Chai O'Clock notifications.

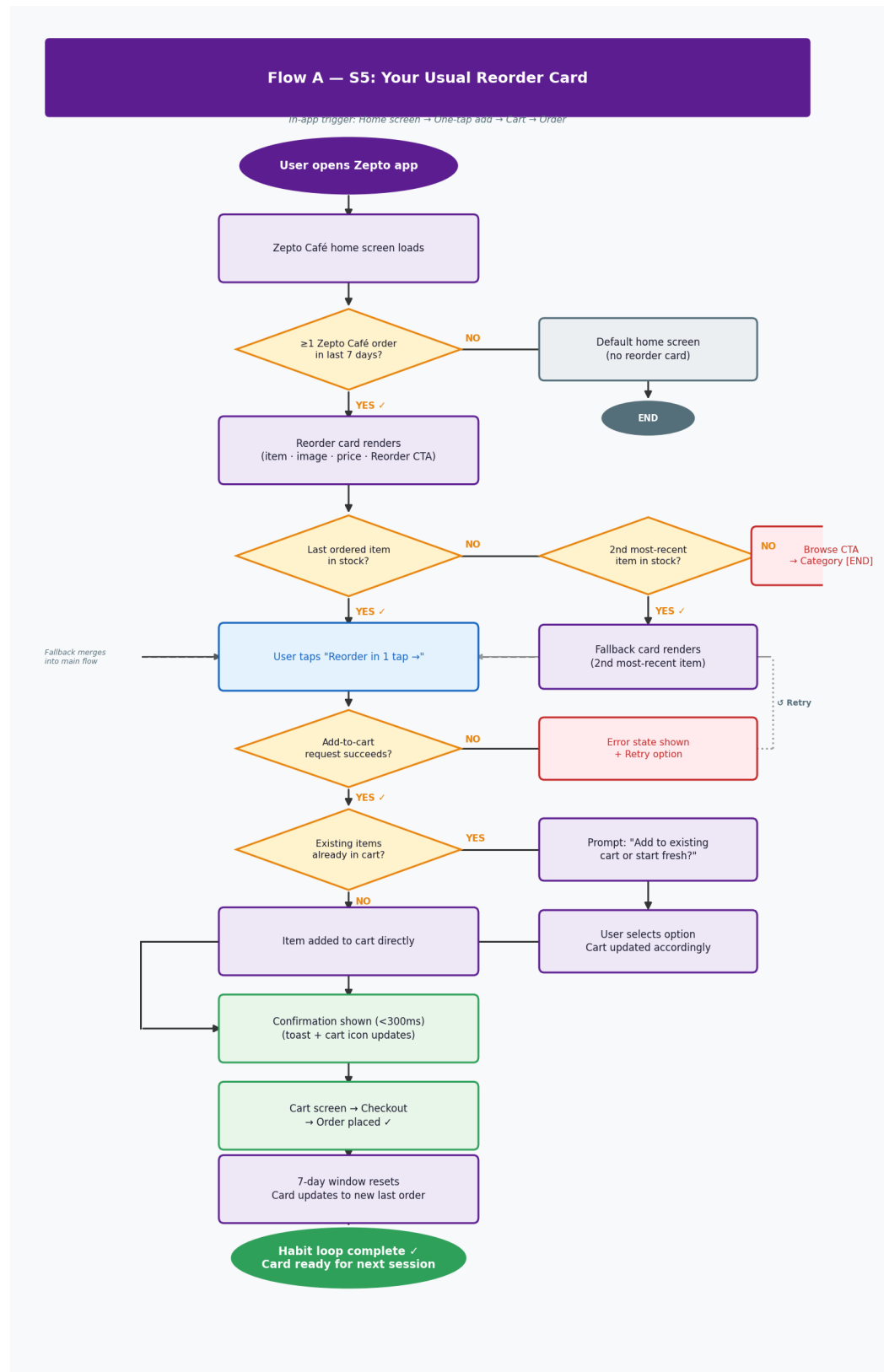
WHEN the user switches the toggle back on.

THEN the Chai O'Clock notification resumes from the next eligible weekday.

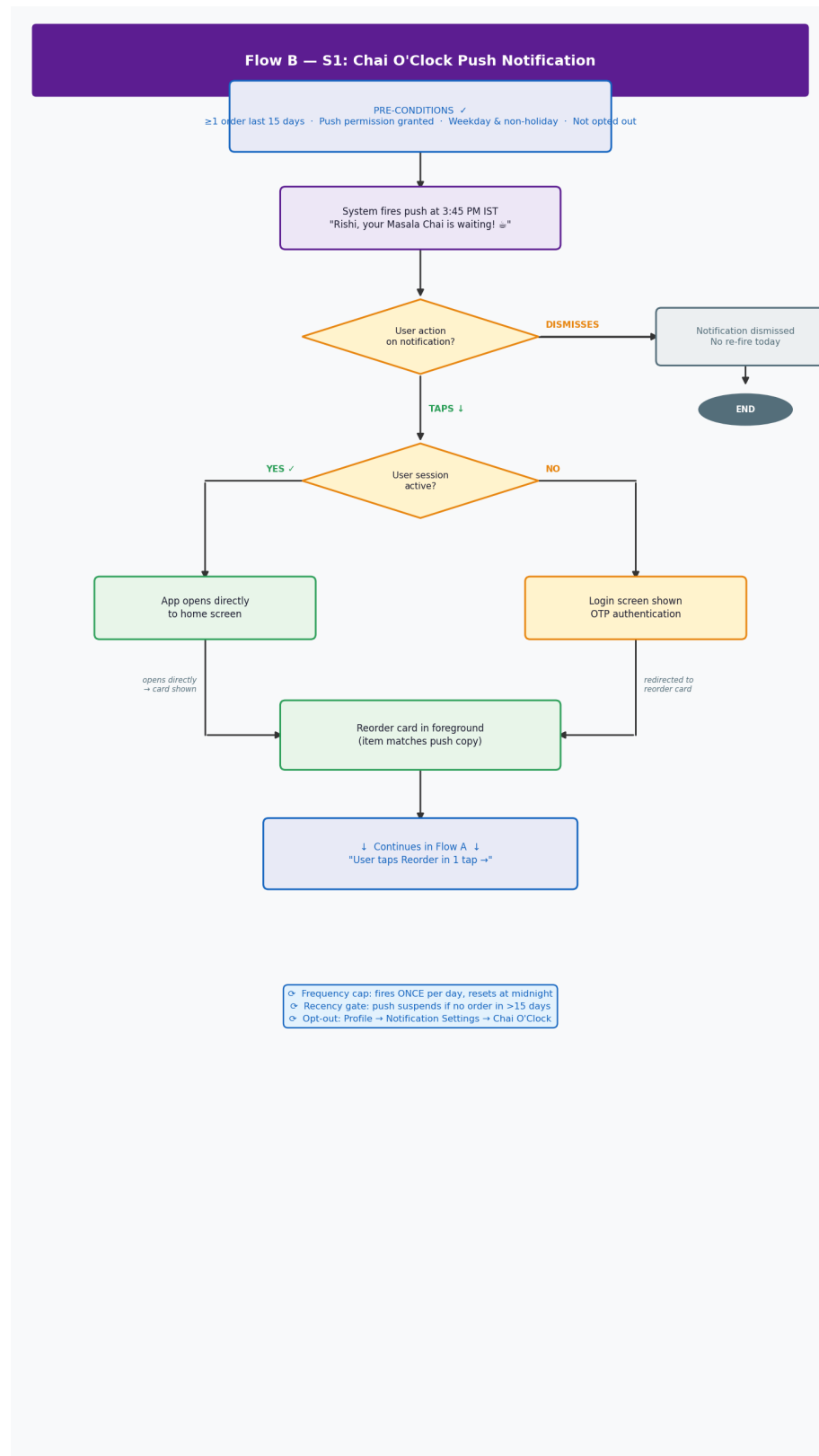
8. Solution User Flow

The flow diagrams below map the complete user journey for both solutions — from trigger to order completion. Flow A covers S5 (Your Usual Reorder Card). Flow B covers S1 (Chai O'Clock Push Notification), which merges into Flow A at the "Reorder in 1 tap" action.

Flow A — S5: Your Usual Reorder Card



Flow B — S1: Chai O'Clock Push Notification



9. Non-Functional Requirements

Performance

- The reorder card (FR-01) must render within 1 second of Zepto Cafe home screen load on a standard 4G connection. Card fetch must not block the rest of the home screen — it loads progressively if needed.
- One-tap add-to-cart (FR-02) must complete and navigate to the cart screen within 1 second of tap under normal network conditions.
- Push notification delivery must occur within the 3:45–3:50pm IST window. Delivery outside this window degrades the use case (user has already left for chai). System retries until 4:00pm; if undelivered by 4:00pm, skipped for that day.

Scalability

- The last-order fetch and reorder card rendering must handle the full eligible concurrent user base at the 3:45–4:00pm peak window without degraded response time. This is the highest-risk window as S1 drives a spike of simultaneous app opens.
- The push notification system must deliver to the full eligible user base within the 5-minute delivery window without queuing delay.

Reliability

- If the last-order fetch fails (network error, timeout), the home screen must degrade gracefully — no broken card state, no crash. The default home screen renders silently.
- Push delivery retries until 4:00pm IST. If undelivered by 4:00pm, the notification is skipped for that day with no late delivery.

Latency

- Cart confirmation feedback (FR-04) must appear within 300ms of tap.
- Deep link resolution from push tap to reorder card (FR-06) must complete within 2 seconds on a standard 4G connection.

Security & Privacy

- Push notification content must not expose order history, item names, or pricing in the notification preview on the lock screen if the user has sensitive notification previews disabled at the OS level.
- If the user is logged out when they tap the push, the reorder card is not rendered until authentication is complete. No order data is visible in a logged-out state.

Error Handling

- All error states across S5 and S1 (failed card fetch, cart failure, push delivery failure) must be logged and trigger an immediate alert to the backend team and the PM.

10. Success Metrics

Primary KPI

Metric	Baseline	Target	Window
30-day repeat rate	12%	25%	6 months post-launch

Feature-Level KPIs

Metric	What It Measures	Target
Reorder card CTR (S5)	% of users who see the card and tap reorder	≥25%
Day-3 return rate	% of first-time users placing a second order within 3 days	≥35%
Day-7 return rate	% of first-time users placing a second order within 7 days	≥30%
Chai O'Clock push open rate (S1)	% of delivered notifications tapped	≥20% (Swiggy benchmark)
Push-to-order conversion	% of push taps resulting in a completed order same session	≥40%
Notification opt-out rate	% of eligible users disabling Chai O'Clock notifications	<1%

Guardrail Metrics (must not worsen)

Metric	Why It Matters
Overall Zepto app uninstall rate	Aggressive push cadence could increase uninstalls if perceived as spam.
Cart abandonment rate on reorder flow	If one-tap reorder creates cart conflicts users abandon, the feature is net negative.
Zepto Cafe home screen load time	Reorder card fetch must not degrade existing home screen performance.

11. Open Points

#	Open Point	Owner	Priority
OP-01	Push timing (3:45–3:50pm) is based on survey self-report, not behavioural app data. Validate against actual Zepto Cafe order time distribution before locking S1 trigger window.	PM + Data	Before Sprint 1
OP-02	Social chai break segment not quantified — users who join group walk-outs are lower-value targets for S1 vs. users who stay desk-bound. Isolate this cohort in the first experiment.	PM + Analytics	Before EXP 2
OP-03	Browse CTA on unavailability state deep-links to last ordered category. Category taxonomy mapping (item → category) needs confirmation from backend.	PM + Engineering	Sprint 1
OP-04	Concurrent user spike at 3:45pm from S1 push — backend capacity needs load testing before launch given all eligible users receive push in a 5-minute window.	Engineering	Before launch
OP-05	S3 Stamp Card (RICE 467) deferred to Phase 2. Revisit once D7 return rate hits ≥30% target — stamp card only compounds an already-working habit loop.	PM	Post-launch
OP-06	P3 Quality perception gap (S9 Post-Order Quality Loop) kept aside. Revisit if reorder rate stalls despite S5 + S1 performing above target.	PM	Post-launch
OP-07	D3 return rate target (35%) exceeds D7 target (30%) — atypical for a cumulative funnel metric. Review and recalibrate after first 30 days of data.	PM	First metrics review
OP-08	Public holiday calendar integration needed for S1 push suppression. Confirm calendar source (national holidays only, or state-level) and ownership.	PM + Engineering	Sprint 1
OP-09	Error alerting: backend team + PM notified on all S5 and S1 error states. Alert tooling, thresholds, and escalation path need definition before launch.	PM + Backend	Before launch